DAN JOHNSTON

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Seeking a creative technical position where my passion and experience can contribute towards building simple, successful, and memorable user experiences.

ABOUT

TBWA\CHIAT\DAY NY — Boston, MA
Associate Director of Technology — *Aug 2022 - Oct 2026*

I currently work in a diverse team of a dozen-odd creative professionals who are focused on building best in class web experiences. Some projects are content heavy—spanning thousands of pages, while others might feature robust data-driven tooling, or custom 3rd party integrations. Depending on the complexity of the ask, timelines range from just a few weeks to the better part of a year.

I have been fortunate to see many successful site launches, which has given me a good sense of how other teams define success and how to best assist them. I work with producers to keep projects on schedule. Providing time estimates and calling out roadblocks well ahead of time. During internal design reviews I can suggest alternatives that address the problem, but with a shorter build time. I'll talk extensively with QA, analytics, strategy, and content teams to ensure the final product matches expectations.

I often lead the technology decisions for the front-end portion of our development work. Typically this includes initial setup and configuration of an open source CMS paired with a React-based framework. Then I'll create a repo and do some basic AWS config. Next I'll set up data models to capture all necessary content, and rough in a "skeleton" of how the various components should fit together. The result should be easy enough for a new developer to pick up quickly, yet complex enough to handle edge cases arising from design and business requirements.

At the end of the day, I just like building cool stuff with great people. I like solving problems I don't already know the answer to. I like being surprised by what I find. I like advocating for others. I also have a security clearance, which is kind of cool.

MullenLowe / Lead Developer	Feb 2020 - Aug 2022
MullenLowe / Senior Developer	Sep 2019 - Feb 2020
MullenLowe / Developer	Apr 2017 - Sep 2019
Mullen / Creative Technologist	June 2015 - Apr 2017

EXPERIENCE

Curiosity.com — Chicago, IL
Front end developer & UX Designer — *May 2014 - June 2015*
Working in a fast paced startup environment on an experimental educational video platform. My team was tasked with creating a unified look and feel from tens of thousands of videos pulled from multiple sources with uneven metadata. During daily stands we decided which KPIs to focus on; based on new API features implemented by the backend team and robust analytics user data. Day to day, I would create detailed

Digital Kitchen / Front end developer — Chicago, IL / Aug 2012 - May 2014

MediumBold / Front end developer — Boston, MA / Jun 2010 - Jun 2012

MIT Mobile Experience Lab — Cambridge, MA
Web & Interactive designer — *Oct 2008 - May 2010*
Starting in a part-time position while in grad school, I transitioned to full-time upon completing my degree. This academic design research lab explored the boundaries of HCI at the time. My role was to support the PI and engineers. I created wireframes, shot videos, built wordpress sites, designed books, posters, and any other collateral as required. Participating in brainstorming and whiteboarding sessions

Commonwealth of Massachusetts (ITD) / Developer — Boston, MA / Aug 2005 - Aug 2007

VPG Integrated Media / Flash Developer & Production Artist — Boston, MA / Jan 2002 - Jul 2005

TOOLS

VS Code, SourceTree, Git, Node, JavaScript, PHP, GraphQL, REST, Xcode, Bash, AWS Amplify, AWS Elastic Beanstalk, AWS EC2, React, Next, Radix, Strapi, Adobe Experience Manager, Figma,

CLIENTS

Century 21, The City of Venice. Corona, Department of Defense, Harvard Business School, HBO, Hyatt, JetBlue, JFK Library & Museum, MIT Media Lab, Monster.com, National

EDUCATION

MFA - Dynamic Media
Massachusetts College of Art and Design, May 2009

BFA - Industrial Design
Rochester Institute of Technology, June 2001

INTERESTS

Cycling, Español, Music, Travel, Journalism, Woodworking, Architecture